

Eretmochelys imbricata

Hawksbill Sea Turtle

Family (Cheloniidae)

Kingdom (Animalia)

Status (Endangered)

Description

One of the smaller sea turtles, it has overlapping scutes that are thicker than those of other sea turtles. This protects them from being battered against sharp coral and rocks during storm events. Adults range in size from 30 to 36 inches carapace length, and weigh 100 to 200 pounds. Its carapace is an attractive dark brown with faint yellow streaks and blotches and a yellow plastron.



Location/Habitat

The species historical range included Alabama, American Samoa, Connecticut, Delaware, Florida, Georgia, Guam, Hawaii, Louisiana, Maryland, Massachusetts, Mississippi, New Jersey, New York, North Carolina, Northern Mariana Islands, Puerto Rico, Rhode Island, South Carolina, Texas, Virginia, Virgin Islands.

Sources: <https://www.fws.gov/species/search>

<https://ecos.fws.gov/ecp/report/species-listings-by-state-totals?statusCategory=Listed>

<https://efotg.sc.egov.usda.gov/#/state/CR/documents/section=4&folder=-3>